



AI-Powered Sales Coaching

How to Coach, Evaluate, and Motivate High-Performing Sales Teams with AI

Course Promise

By the end of this course, you will build a practical **AI Sales Coaching Toolkit** you can use with your team immediately.

Core Question

What can I now do **better with AI** as a sales coach than I could do before?

What This Course Will Help You Do

You will learn how to use AI to transform every dimension of your sales coaching practice — from diagnosis to motivation.



Diagnose Gaps

Identify rep performance gaps with precision



Better Conversations

Prepare stronger coaching and discovery conversations



Pipeline Quality

Evaluate pipeline and deal quality accurately



Motivate Reps

Give clearer feedback and motivate different rep types



Role-Play Practice

Create realistic role-play drills and development plans



Stronger 1-on-1s

Run more effective one-on-one coaching sessions



Final Output: Your complete AI Sales Coaching Toolkit — ready to use with your team from day one.

The New Role of the AI-Powered Sales Coach

LEARNING OBJECTIVE

Explain how AI changes the sales manager's coaching role and identify where AI can support better coaching decisions.

Great coaching is not just telling reps what to do.

Truly effective coaching is a multi-dimensional practice that requires observation, diagnosis, and consistent follow-through.

→ Observing Behavior

Watching what reps actually do in the field

→ Diagnosing Gaps

Identifying the root cause behind underperformance

→ Asking Useful Questions

Prompting reps to think, not just comply

→ Practicing Skills

Drilling the behaviors that drive results

→ Following Up Consistently

Holding reps accountable over time

How AI Elevates Coaching

AI helps managers:

- **Prepare faster** — spend less time gathering data, more time coaching
- **Spot patterns** — identify trends across reps and time periods
- **Coach more consistently** — apply the same rigor to every rep, every week



Manager Example: Coaching at Scale

REAL-WORLD SCENARIO

A frontline manager has **eight reps** and limited time. Instead of waiting until the monthly pipeline review, the manager uses AI **every Friday** to stay ahead of performance issues.

1

Summarize Rep Activity

Pull together the week's key activity metrics across all eight reps in minutes

2

Identify Coaching Themes

Spot recurring patterns and issues that need attention before they compound

3

Prepare Targeted Questions

Generate specific, evidence-based questions for each rep's situation

4

Plan Next-Week Priorities

Enter every week with a clear coaching agenda rather than reacting on the fly



Manager Shift: From ~~reactive coaching~~ to **prepared coaching** — the difference between putting out fires and building a high-performance culture.

AI Prompt: Weekly Coaching Priorities

✧ AI PROMPT TEMPLATE

Use this prompt every Friday to generate a structured coaching plan for the week ahead:

"Act as a sales leadership coach. I manage a team of sales reps. Based on the following notes and performance data, identify the top 3 coaching priorities, the likely behavior behind each issue, and one coaching question I should ask each rep. Format the output as a manager coaching plan."

Use This For

- Weekly coaching prep
- Team performance reviews
- One-on-one planning

Expected Output

- Top 3 coaching priorities
- Likely behavior behind each issue
- One coaching question per rep

AI Practice: Sort the Coaching Challenge

PRACTICE ACTIVITY

Choose **three current coaching challenges** from your team and use AI to classify each one into the right category.

Skill Gap

The rep lacks the ability or technique to perform the behavior

Will Gap

The rep has the skill but lacks motivation or commitment

Process Gap

The rep is not following the right steps or sequence

Pipeline Quality Gap

The rep's deals lack the evidence needed to forecast accurately



Follow-Up Prompt: "What evidence would confirm or challenge this diagnosis?" — Always pressure-test your AI output before acting on it.



Manager Action Step: Use AI to prepare one coaching conversation before your next one-on-one.

Business Outcome: More consistent coaching and faster identification of performance issues.

Diagnosing Performance Gaps with AI

LEARNING OBJECTIVE

Use AI to analyze sales performance data and distinguish between activity, skill, process, pipeline, and motivation gaps.

Do not coach the symptom before diagnosing the cause.

Low performance can stem from many different root causes. Misdiagnosing the gap leads to wasted coaching time and frustrated reps.

Not Enough Activity

Rep is simply not making enough calls, emails, or outreach attempts

Weak Messaging

Rep is active but the message isn't resonating with buyers

Poor Discovery

Rep moves too fast without understanding buyer needs

Low Conversion

Rep struggles to move prospects from one stage to the next

Poor Follow-Up

Rep fails to maintain momentum after initial contact

Weak Deal Quality

Pipeline is full but deals lack evidence of real buyer commitment

Low Confidence or Motivation

Rep has the skills but isn't bringing energy or belief to the work

Manager Example: High Activity, Low Conversion

REAL-WORLD SCENARIO

A rep is making **enough calls** but booking **very few meetings**. The manager uses AI to compare multiple data points before drawing any conclusions.

1

Call Volume

Is the rep making enough attempts?

2

Email Quality

Are the messages compelling and relevant?

3

Target Accounts

Is the rep calling the right people?

4

Conversion Rate

Where exactly is the drop-off happening?

5

Follow-Up Patterns

Is the rep following up consistently?

The Diagnosis

The issue may be **message quality**, not effort. The rep is working hard — but saying the wrong things.

The Coaching Move

Coach the **message** before asking for more activity. Increasing call volume without fixing the message only amplifies the problem.



Never prescribe more activity when the root cause is a skill or message gap.

AI Prompt: Rep Performance Diagnosis

☆ AI PROMPT TEMPLATE

Use this structured prompt to generate a comprehensive root-cause analysis for any underperforming rep:

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"Act as a sales performance analyst and coaching partner. Review this rep performance snapshot: [insert activity, conversion, pipeline, win rate, notes]. Identify the most likely root causes of the performance gap. Separate your analysis into activity gap, skill gap, process gap, deal quality gap, and motivation gap. Recommend 3 coaching actions."
```

The AI will return a structured output you can use directly in your coaching conversation:

Likely Root Cause The primary driver of underperformance	Evidence Data points that support the diagnosis
Coaching Risk What could go wrong if you coach the wrong thing	Recommended Next Step The specific coaching action to take first

AI Practice: Challenge the Diagnosis

PRACTICE ACTIVITY

Use a sample rep performance scenario to practice the full diagnostic loop — from initial hypothesis to evidence-based coaching plan.



Step 1: Ask AI to Diagnose the Gap

Input the rep's performance data and ask AI to identify the most likely root cause



Step 2: Challenge the Diagnosis

Ask AI: "What evidence would confirm or disprove this diagnosis?" — force the AI to stress-test its own output



Step 3: Revise the Coaching Plan

Update the plan based on what evidence is missing — don't coach until you have enough data



Manager Action Step: Bring one rep's performance data to AI and generate a root-cause coaching hypothesis before your next one-on-one.



Business Outcome: Better coaching accuracy and less wasted coaching time — every session focused on the real issue.

Coaching Sales Conversations and Discovery Skills

LEARNING OBJECTIVE

Use AI to improve how reps ask questions, uncover needs, qualify opportunities, and guide sales conversations.

Discovery is one of the most coachable sales skills.

Unlike closing or negotiation, discovery is a structured skill that can be broken down, practiced, and improved with deliberate coaching.

Managers Should Coach Reps To:

- **Ask Better Questions**
Move from surface-level to business-impact questions
- **Listen for Business Impact**
Hear what matters most to the buyer's business
- **Clarify Urgency**
Understand why the buyer needs to act now
- **Understand Decision Criteria**
Know how the buyer will evaluate and choose
- **Connect Solutions to Buyer Priorities**
Link your offering to what the buyer actually cares about

Manager Example: Presenting Too Early

REAL-WORLD SCENARIO

A rep keeps **presenting too early** in discovery calls — jumping to the pitch before truly understanding the buyer's situation.

Missed Discovery Questions

The rep skips key questions about business pain, urgency, and impact — moving straight to features

Weak Follow-Up Moments

When the buyer hints at a deeper issue, the rep doesn't probe — missing the real opportunity

Premature Assumptions

The rep assumes they know what the buyer needs and starts solving before confirming the problem

Unexplored Business Impact

The conversation never reaches the "so what" — the cost of the problem to the buyer's business

  **Coaching Focus:** Slow down. Ask deeper questions before pitching. The best salespeople are the best listeners — not the best talkers.

AI Prompt: Discovery Call Coaching

🔗 AI PROMPT TEMPLATE

After any discovery call, use this prompt to generate specific, actionable coaching feedback:

"Act as a sales discovery coach. Review this discovery call summary or transcript. Identify 3 moments where the rep could have asked a stronger question. Rewrite each question to uncover business impact, urgency, decision process, or buyer motivation. Then suggest one practice drill for the rep."

Use This After:

- Discovery calls
- Demo prep sessions
- Lost deal reviews
- New rep coaching sessions

AI Will Return:

- 3 specific missed moments
- Rewritten stronger questions
- One targeted practice drill

AI Practice: Improve the Question

PRACTICE ACTIVITY

Paste a sample discovery call summary into AI and run through this complete coaching and practice sequence.

Identify Weak Questions

Ask AI to flag the moments where the rep's questions were surface-level or closed-ended

Rewrite Stronger Questions

Ask AI to rewrite each weak question to uncover business impact, urgency, or decision criteria

Suggest Follow-Up Questions

Ask AI to generate follow-up questions the rep could have used to go deeper

Create a Practice Drill

Ask AI to design a 5-minute role-play drill targeting the specific skill gap identified

  **Role-Play Mode:** AI plays the buyer. You play the rep. AI gives feedback after each exchange — a complete practice loop in minutes.

  **Manager Action Step:** Coach one discovery skill this week using this exact sequence.

  **Business Outcome:** Stronger discovery, better qualification, and improved conversion rates across your team.

Evaluating Pipeline, Activity, and Deal Quality

LEARNING OBJECTIVE

Use AI to evaluate whether pipeline health is based on **real opportunity quality** rather than optimistic forecasting.

Pipeline coaching should focus on evidence — not hope.

What to Look for in Every Deal:

Buyer Commitment

Has the buyer taken a meaningful action that signals real interest?

Clear Next Steps

Is there a specific, agreed-upon next action with a date?

Decision Process

Does the rep know how and when the buyer will decide?

Business Pain

Is there a documented, quantified problem the buyer needs to solve?

Budget or Priority

Has the buyer confirmed this is funded and a current priority?

Stakeholder Access

Is the rep talking to the people who can actually say yes?

Deal Risk

What could cause this deal to stall, shrink, or be lost?

Manager Reminder

Pipeline size $\neq$ Pipeline quality

A large pipeline full of weak deals is more dangerous than a small pipeline of well-qualified opportunities. AI helps you tell the difference — fast.



Never let a rep's optimism substitute for buyer evidence in your pipeline reviews.



Manager Example: Pipeline Optimism

SLIDE 16

A rep shows strong pipeline coverage, but many deals have vague next steps. The manager uses AI to cut through the noise and surface what's real.

Real Opportunities

Deals with clear evidence, defined next steps, and engaged buyers

Stalled Opportunities

Deals with no recent activity or unclear momentum

Risky Opportunities

Deals with missing stakeholders or unresolved objections

Poorly Qualified

Deals that lack budget, authority, or a compelling reason to buy



Coaching Focus: Move from "What do you think will close?" to "What evidence supports this forecast?"

AI Prompt: Deal Review Coach

SLIDE 17

"Act as a sales pipeline coach. Review the following deal notes. Score each deal from 1 to 5 for qualification strength, buyer urgency, decision process clarity, next-step quality, and forecast confidence. Identify coaching questions I should ask the rep during our deal review."

Expected Output Format

1

Deal Score

1-5 rating across five dimensions

2

Risk Factors

Key threats to deal progression

3

Missing Evidence

Gaps in qualification or buyer intent

4

Coaching Questions

Questions to ask the rep in review

5

Next Action

Recommended step to advance the deal

AI Practice: Evidence vs. Optimism

SLIDE 18

Practice Activity

Analyze three sample deal summaries with AI. Ask:

"Separate pipeline optimism from pipeline evidence. What do we know, what are we assuming, and what should the rep verify next?"

1

Deal Review This Week

Manager Action Step: Use AI to prepare one deal review this week

Three Key Questions AI Helps Answer

→ What do we *know*?

Confirmed facts from buyer interactions and documented activity

→ What are we *assuming*?

Beliefs not yet validated by buyer behavior or explicit confirmation

→ What should the rep *verify*?

Specific next steps to close evidence gaps before the next forecast

3x

Forecast Accuracy

Business Outcome: Improved forecast accuracy and fewer pipeline surprises

Giving Better Feedback with AI Support

SLIDE 19

Learning Objective: Use AI to prepare feedback that is specific, balanced, behavior-based, and actionable.

What Good Feedback Looks Like



Clear



Timely



Specific



Behavior-Based



Actionable



Supportive

The Feedback Formula



✗ Avoid vague feedback like: "Be more proactive."



✓ Better feedback explains:

What happened → Why it matters → What to do next

Manager Example: Weak Follow-Up

SLIDE 20

A manager needs to tell a rep that their follow-up is too slow and too generic. Here's how AI transforms the message.

✗ Before AI

"You need to follow up better."

Vague, unhelpful, and easy to dismiss. The rep doesn't know what to change.

✓ After AI Rewrite

Specific behavior + business impact + supportive tone + clear next step

The rep understands exactly what happened and what to do differently.

AI Rewrites Feedback Across Four Dimensions

Specific Behavior

Names the exact action or pattern that needs to change

Business Impact

Connects the behavior to deal outcomes and team performance

Supportive Tone

Keeps the message respectful and motivating, not punitive

Clear Next Step

Gives the rep a concrete action to take immediately

📌 **Coaching Focus:** Make feedback easier to understand and easier to act on.

AI Prompt: Rewrite Feedback

SLIDE 21

"Act as a sales leadership feedback coach. Rewrite the following feedback so it is specific, respectful, behavior-based, and actionable. Include one strength, one improvement area, one example, and one next step. Keep the tone direct but supportive. Feedback draft: [insert draft]."

Prompt Structure

01

One Strength

Acknowledge what the rep is doing well

02

One Improvement Area

Name the specific behavior to change

03

One Example

Ground the feedback in a real, observable moment

04

One Next Step

Give the rep a clear, immediate action

Optional Follow-Up Prompt



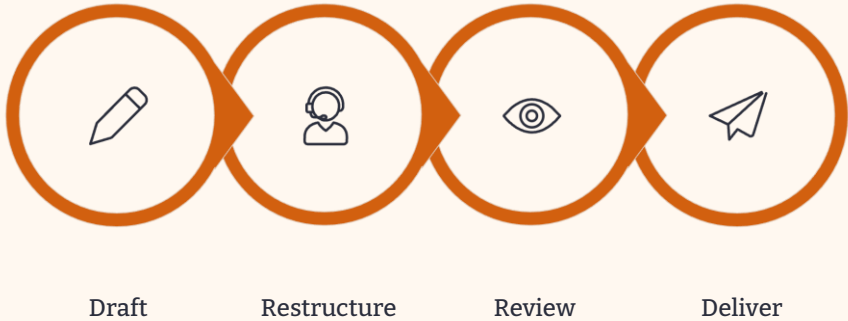
"Make this sound more conversational and less formal."

Use this follow-up when the AI output feels too stiff or corporate. The goal is feedback that sounds like *you* — not a performance review template.

AI Practice: Feedback Upgrade

SLIDE 22

Write a rough feedback message you might give to a rep, then ask AI to improve it using a proven structure.



This process transforms vague impressions into structured, actionable coaching that reps can actually use.

The AI Feedback Structure



👉 **Business Outcome:** Clearer feedback, stronger trust, and better rep accountability.



Motivating High Performers and Struggling Reps

SLIDE 23

Learning Objective: Use AI to tailor motivation, recognition, and encouragement to different rep needs and performance levels.

- 📌 **Sales Coaching Concept:** Motivation is not one-size-fits-all. What energizes a top performer may overwhelm a struggling rep — and vice versa.

High Performers Need

- 📌 **Challenge**
Stretch goals that push beyond current comfort zones
- 📌 **Autonomy**
Freedom to own their approach and strategy
- 📌 **Recognition**
Public and meaningful acknowledgment of results
- 📌 **Growth Opportunities**
Paths to advance skills, influence, and career

Struggling Reps Need

- 📌 **Clarity**
Simple, focused priorities without overwhelm
- 📌 **Confidence**
Encouragement grounded in real progress
- 📌 **Structure**
A clear plan with defined milestones
- 📌 **Small Wins**
Early successes that rebuild momentum

Manager Example: Two Reps, Two Needs

SLIDE 24

One top performer feels underchallenged. One newer rep is losing confidence after missed targets. The manager uses AI to prepare two completely different approaches.



For the High Performer

- **Stretch Goal:** A new challenge that raises the ceiling
- **Strategic Recognition:** Acknowledge impact, not just numbers
- **Growth Challenge:** Mentoring, leading a project, or new territory



For the Struggling Rep

- **Encouragement:** Specific, genuine recognition of effort
- **Clear Short-Term Target:** One achievable goal this week
- **Practice Plan:** Structured skill-building with manager support

 AI helps managers prepare both conversations in minutes — not hours.



AI Prompt: Motivation and Recognition

SLIDE 25

"Act as a sales motivation coach. I have a rep who is [describe situation]. Help me identify what may be affecting their motivation. Suggest 3 ways to motivate them that are specific, respectful, and tied to performance. Include one recognition message, one coaching question, and one development challenge."

Use This Prompt For

Recognition

Craft meaningful acknowledgment tied to specific behaviors and results

Confidence-Building

Rebuild momentum for reps who are struggling or doubting themselves

Re-Engagement

Re-energize reps who have gone quiet or disengaged from the team

Stretch Assignments

Design growth challenges that push high performers to the next level

AI Practice: Personalize the Motivation

SLIDE 26

Choose two rep profiles and ask AI to create tailored motivation strategies for each. Then revise the output so it sounds like you.

Profile 1: High Performer

A rep who has consistently exceeded quota but seems bored and disengaged in team meetings.

Ask AI to create:

- A stretch challenge tied to their strengths
- A recognition message that goes beyond the numbers
- A development opportunity that excites them

1

Recognition Message

Give one personalized recognition message this week

Profile 2: Struggling Rep

A newer rep who has missed their last two targets and is visibly losing confidence.

Ask AI to create:

- An encouragement message grounded in real progress
- A clear, achievable short-term goal
- A structured practice plan with manager check-ins

1

Development Challenge

Give one personalized development challenge this week

✓ **Business Outcome:** Higher engagement, stronger morale, and better performance consistency.

Using AI Role-Play for Skill Practice

SLIDE 27

Learning Objective: Use AI as a role-play partner to help reps practice sales conversations before they happen with real buyers.

 **Sales Coaching Concept:** Skill improvement requires practice. AI role-play gives reps a safe space to fail, learn, and improve — before the stakes are real.

AI Role-Play Can Help Reps Practice



Discovery

Asking better questions to uncover real buyer needs



Pricing Conversations

Defending value and navigating discount pressure



Renewal Conversations

Retaining customers and expanding relationships



Objection Handling

Responding to price, timing, and competitor objections



Negotiation

Reaching agreement without giving away margin



Executive Conversations

Engaging C-suite buyers with strategic relevance



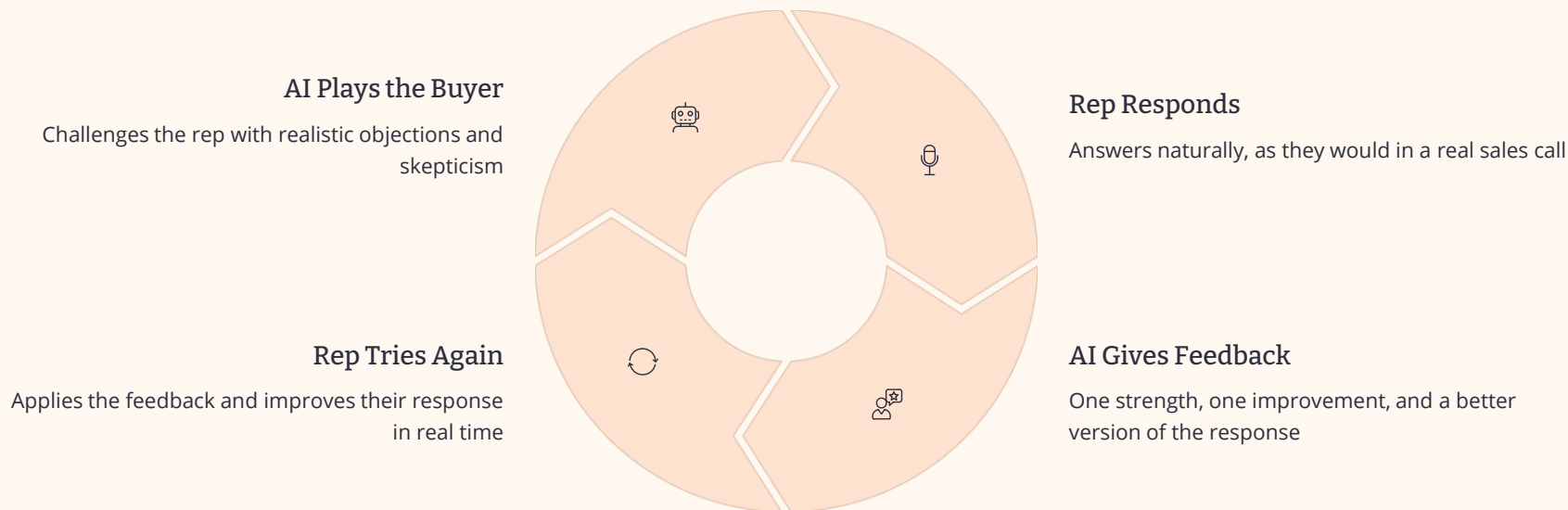
Manager Reminder: Practice before the high-stakes moment — not during it.

AI Prompt: Sales Role-Play Partner

SLIDE 28

"Act as a skeptical buyer in a sales role-play. You are interested but concerned that our solution is too expensive. Challenge my responses realistically. After each response, give me one strength, one improvement suggestion, and a better version of what I could say. Do not make it easy."

How the Role-Play Loop Works



AI Practice: Two-Round Role-Play

SLIDE 29

Run a live AI role-play for one common sales challenge. The two-round format forces real improvement — not just repetition.



Round 1: Respond Naturally

Answer the AI buyer's challenge as you normally would. Don't overthink it — respond instinctively.



Request AI Feedback

Ask for one strength and one specific improvement suggestion from the AI after your response.



Round 2: Apply the Feedback

Try again using the AI's coaching. Notice the difference in your response quality and confidence.

Manager Action Step

Assign one AI role-play practice to a rep before their next high-stakes call. Make it specific to the actual challenge they're facing.

Business Outcome

- Better call readiness before high-stakes moments
- Stronger rep confidence going into difficult conversations
- Faster skill development through immediate, personalized feedback

Final Activity: Build Your AI Sales Coaching Toolkit

SLIDE 30

Learning Objective: Build a reusable AI toolkit that supports weekly coaching, evaluation, feedback, motivation, role-play, and development planning.

Your Toolkit Should Include

1	Rep Performance Analysis Prompt to evaluate rep activity, pipeline, and results
2	Coaching Conversation Prep Prompt to structure your next 1-on-1 with purpose and focus
3	Deal Review Prompt to score deals and surface coaching questions
4	Discovery Coaching Prompt to evaluate and improve rep discovery skills
5	Feedback Rewriting Prompt to transform vague feedback into specific, actionable coaching
6	Motivation & Recognition Prompt to personalize encouragement for any rep situation
7	Role-Play Partner Prompt to run realistic practice conversations before high-stakes calls
8	Individual Development Plan Prompt to build a structured growth plan for each rep
9	One-on-One Planning Prompt to prepare focused, productive weekly check-ins
10	Weekly Coaching Workflow A repeatable system that ties all prompts into a consistent rhythm



Manager Action Step: Pilot your AI Sales Coaching Toolkit with one rep or one team coaching theme within the next week. **Business Outcome:** A sustainable coaching rhythm that improves consistency, clarity, and team performance.